

Dempster Highway Extension

An ice road built on the frozen Mackenzie River and Arctic Ocean, it provides a winter route to the isolated community of Tuktoyaktuk.

Mountain roads and passes

1 Trollstigen, Norway

This dramatic road's name means "Trolls' ladder." It has 11 hairpin bends, which wind up the steep mountainside.

2 Stelvio Pass, Italy

One of the highest roads in the Alps, its 60 hairpin bends provide a challenge for both drivers and bicyclers.

3 Khardung La, India

This famously high mountain pass in the Ladakh part of Kashmir was built in 1976 and opened to motor vehicles in 1988.

4 Semo La, Tibet, China

Possibly the highest vehicle-accessible pass in the world, it was reliably measured in 1999 at 18,258 ft (5,565 m).

5 Irohazaka Winding Road

Each of the 48 hairpin turns on this route in Japan is labeled with one of the 48 characters of the Japanese alphabet.

Bonn-Köln Autobahn

Built in 1932, it was the first road designed exclusively for cars, with divided lanes and no intersections with other roads.

Tibbit to Contwoyto Winter Road

An ice road built over frozen lakes, it is open for about 10 weeks from late January each year.

Pacific Coast Highway

This world-famous route hugs the California coast from Orange County in the south to the forests of giant redwood trees in the north.

Cabot Trail

Looping around the northern tip of Cape Breton Island, Nova Scotia, and named after 16th-century Italian explorer, John Cabot.

Route 66

A 2,448-mile (3,940-km) road that follows the historic route taken by migrants to California during the Great Depression.

Natchez Trace Parkway

A route used by Native Americans and their animals for thousands of years before the modern road was built.

Darién Gap, Panama

A stretch of rainforest that breaks the Pan-American Highway's route.

Pan-American Highway

About 29,800 miles (48,000 km) long, it runs through 18 countries, from Alaska to the southern tip of Argentina.

Yungas Road, Bolivia

A single-track mountain road heavily used by trucks but with unprotected sheer drops of 1,970 ft (600 m). Up to 300 travelers are killed on the route every year.

World's busiest roads

1 Ontario Highway 401, Canada

The busiest highway in North America—more than 440,000 vehicles pass through the Toronto section every day. It is also one of the widest in the world—some sections of the route have 18 lanes.

2 Interstate 405, California

Runs north from the city of Irvine in Orange County to San Fernando, a route that is known as the northern segment of the San Diego Freeway. This freeway is the busiest and most congested in the US, carrying up to 379,000 vehicles a day.



HIGHWAY 401, ONTARIO, CANADA

Roads

The planet is now more accessible by road than it has ever been. There are about 65 million miles (104 million km) of roads on Earth, from multilane urban freeways to seasonal ice roads made from frozen lakes and seas.